

CHAPTER

3



Amlapitta

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Amlapitta
- ⇒ To learn the Nidana (aetiology) and Samprapti of the disease along with the understanding of western physiology
- ⇒ To learn the Purvarupa, Samanya Lakshana, Vishishta Lakshana and Sadhyasadyata of the disease along with understanding of western physiology
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease

Introduction

अम्लपित्तं चेति अम्लगुणोद्विक्तं पित्तम्॥

Chakra, Ca.Ci. – 15/47

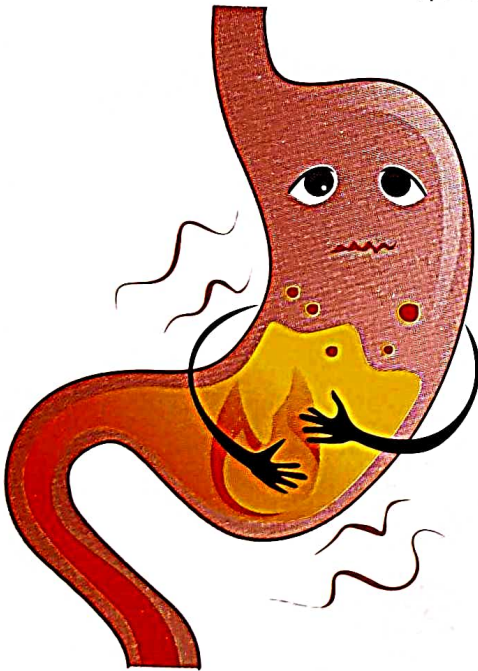


Figure 6: Pratyatma Lakshana of Amlapitta

Amlapitta is a spectrum of diseases where the individual presents with burning sensation in the chest and sour or bitter taste in the mouth frequently. This usually occurs

in the patients who are having the chronic exposure to Pitta vitiating etiological factors. Annavaha, Pranavaha and Rasavaha Srotas will be afflicted during the pathogenesis. As the person of Amlapitta will have exposure from oral cavity, there will be affliction of Annavaha and Pranavaha Srotas in most of the occasions. Purishavaha Srotas affliction can be observed in the patient who is having downward movement of morbid Dosha in Mahasrotas (gastrointestinal tract). This is considered to be the Pitta dominant illness, afflicting Rasa Dhatu involving Annavaha, Pranavaha and Rasavaha Srotas. This is usually manifested due to Sanga and Vimargagamana. When you observe the aetiological factors, most of the causes will be responsible for the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta in the body. As far as the type of Vyadhi is concerned, Amlapitta is categorized under Sharirika variety of Doshabala Pravritta Vikara of Adhyatmika Vikara.

Amlapitta Nidana

बिरुद्धदुष्टाम्लविदाहिपित्तप्रकोपपानान्नभुजो विदग्धम्।
पित्तं स्वहेतूपचितं पुरा यत्तदम्लपित्तं प्रवदन्ति सन्तः॥१॥

Ma.Ni. – 51/1

- ⊗ Excess consumption of Viruddha Ahara¹ e.g. consumption of milk and fish together; consumption of ghee and honey together etc
- ⊗ Consumption of stale food

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1 पाण्ड्यान्धवीसपेदकोदराणां विस्फोटकोन्मादभगन्दराणाम्। मूर्च्छामदाध्मानगलग्रहाणां 'पाण्ड्यामयस्यामविषस्य चैव॥१०२॥
किलास कुष्ठग्रहणीगदानां शोथाम्लपित्तज्वर पीनसानाम्। सन्तानदोषस्य तथैव मृत्योविरुद्धमन्नं प्रवदन्ति हेतुम्॥१०३॥

Amlapitta is one of the many Vikara manifested due to the frequent consumption in Viruddha Ahara.

Ca.Su. – 26/102, 103

- Excess consumption of *Amla* (sour) *Rasa* substances²
- Excess consumption of *Vidahi* (burning sensation in the chest and thirst inducing) substances³
- Excess consumption of foods and drinks which vitiate the *Pitta Dosha* in the body⁴

Samprapti Ghataka

- Dosha : Pitta**
- Dushya : Rasa**
- Srotas : Annavaha, Pranavaha and Rasavaha Srotas in Urdhvaga Amlapitta; Annavaha, Purishavaha and Rasavaha Srotas in case of Adhoga Amlapitta**
- Srotodushti Prakara: Sanga and Vimargagamana**
- Agni : Jatharagnimandya**
- Ama : Jatharagnimandyaajanya**
- Udbhava Sthana : Amashaya**
- Sanchara Sthana : Sarva Sharira (in case of involvement of Rasa Dhatu)**

- Vyakta Sthana : Vaktra**
- Rogamarga : Abhyantra and Bahya**
- Vyadhi Svabhava : Ashukari or Chirakari**
- Sadhyasadhyata : Sadhya to Pratyakhyeya** depending upon the duration and progression of the disease

Amlapitta Samanya Lakshana

अविपाकमोक्लेशतिकाग्नौरवैः।

हृत्कण्ठदाहारुचिभ्रिचाम्लपित्तं वदेद्विषक्॥२॥

Ma.Ni. – 51/2

- Impaired digestion⁵
- Exhaustion without any physical activities⁶
- Nausea⁷
- Bitter or sour eructations in the mouth⁸
- Heaviness of the abdomen⁹
- Burning sensation in the chest
- Burning sensation in the throat¹⁰
- Tastelessness¹¹

- The term stale food refers to no longer a fresh food. This is responsible for the proliferation of microorganisms. If a person consumes such type of food substances, that may lead to the inflammation of gastric mucosa and thus the person may present with burning sensation in the epigastric region. Nowadays, most of the individuals consume items prepared in bakeries, if kept for longer time in room temperature, there may be likely proliferation of the fungi on the bakery items, bread and buns in particular. These are responsible for inflammation of the upper alimentary canal.
- Vidahi* substances are having *Tejo Mahabhuta* predominance in them. Excess consumption of these substances are likely to increase the *Pitta Dosha* abnormally. These substances are likely to increase the acidity of chyme which in turn increase the concentration of hydrochloric acid in the stomach and this is responsible for the inhibitory movement of acidic chyme into the duodenum which in turn leads to the reverse peristaltic movement of these food substances. Thus, the person may present with burning sensation in the retrosternal region, throat and mouth associated with sour or bitter eructations.
- Pitta* vitiating substances are having *Tejo Mahabhuta* predominance in them. Excess consumption of these substances are likely to increase the *Pitta Dosha* abnormally. These substances are likely to increase the acidity of chyme which in turn increase the concentration of hydrochloric acid in the stomach and this is responsible for the inhibitory movement of acidic chyme into the duodenum which in turn leads to the reverse peristaltic movement of these food substances. Thus, the person may present with burning sensation in the retrosternal region, throat and mouth associated with sour or bitter eructations.
- This is attributable to the impaired digestion occurring in an individual due to abnormal *Pitta* function. Indigestion can occur due to abnormal *Vata* or *Kapha* functioning in the body. In this occasion, we can see most of the aetiological factors are *Pitta* vitiating ones and these are usually responsible for the *Pitta* vitiation which in turn responsible for the impaired digestion. This can occur due to the abnormal *Drava* (liquid), *Tikshna* (sharp potency), *Laghu* (light to digest), *Snigdha* (unctuous) qualities in the body.
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- This is attributable to the presence of irritating substances in the gastrointestinal tract either in the stomach or duodenum. This will increase the contents in the stomach and/ or duodenum which may result in nausea and this will be followed by vomiting.
- This is attributable to the presence of irritating substances in the gastrointestinal tract either in the stomach or duodenum. This will increase the contents in the stomach and/ or duodenum because of inward movement of fluid from the mucosa of stomach into the stomach diluting the gastric juice. This will increase the volume of stomach content, which may result in nausea and this will be followed by vomiting.
- Heaviness of the abdomen is attributable to the presence of macromolecules or intermediate molecules in the stomach due to partial digestion or complete indigestion of the food.
- This is attributable to the increase *Pitta Dosha* in *Amashaya*. This *Lakshana* occurs as a result of continuous exposure to aetiological factors which increase *Tejo Mahabhuta* in the body. There will be reverse peristaltic movement of partially digested substances. These substances contain hydrochloric acid too. That is the reason, when the person has this symptom, it indicates that there is presence of hydrochloric acid in the contents of the stomach.
- This is attributable to dilution of gastric juices. When an individual consumes excess spicy substances, that will lead to the increased secretion of mucus which protects the gastric mucosa from these irritating substances. This mechanism will dilute the gastric juices and the person may have tastelessness or unable to perceive the taste when he has developed eructation..

Bheda of Amlapitta

2 types depending upon the movement of Dosha in the body:

1. Urdhvaga Amlapitta
2. Adhoga Amlapitta

4 types depending upon the Dosha dominance in the manifestation of the disease

1. Vataja Amlapitta
2. Vata Kaphaja Amlapitta
3. Kaphaja Amlapitta
4. Kapha Pittaja Amlapitta

Adhoga Amlapitta

तृदाहमुच्छोभ्रममोहकारि प्रयात्यधो वा विविधप्रकारम्
हृत्लासकोठानलसादहर्षस्वेदाङ्गपीतत्वकरं कदाचित्॥३॥

Ma.Ni. - 51/3

- Thirst
- Burning sensation in the abdomen
- Altered state of consciousness
- Giddiness
- Confusion
- Nausea
- Skin eruption
- Loss of appetite
- Horripilation
- Excess sweating
- Yellowish discolouration of the body parts

Urdhvaga Amlapitta

वान्तं हरित्पीतकनीलकृष्णमारकरक्ताभमतीव चाम्लम्।
मांसोदकामं त्वतिपिच्छिलाच्छं श्लेष्मानुजातं विविधं रसेन॥४॥
भुक्ते विदग्धे त्वथवाऽप्यभुक्ते करोति तिक्ताम्लवर्णिं कदाचित्।
उद्गारमेवंविधमेव कण्ठहृत्कुक्षिदाहं शिरसो रुजं च॥५॥
करचरणदाहमौष्ण्यं महतीमरुचि ज्वरं च कफपित्तम्।
जनयति कण्डूमण्डलपिडकाशत निक्षितगात्ररोगचयम्॥६॥

Ma.Ni. - 51/4-6

- Vomiting with vomitus having greenish, yellowish, bluish, blackish, reddish discolouration or frank blood in the vomitus
- Sour eructation in the mouth
- Sometimes the colour of vomitus will be similar to the colour of meat soup and excess slimy and clear content.
- Vomiting associated with bitter or sour taste when the person is doing fasting or during digestion of food
- Bitter or sour eructation

- Burning sensation in the throat, chest and abdomen
- Headache
- Burning sensation in the palms and soles
- Warmth in the palms and soles
- Tastelessness
- Raised body temperature
- When the person is having the Kapha and Pitta during the manifestation, there will be Itching
- Skin eruptions

Vataja Amlapitta

कम्पप्रलापमूर्च्छाचि मिचि मिगानाबादशूलानि।
तमसो दर्शनविभ्रम विमोहहर्षाण्यनिलकोर्पात्॥९॥

Ma.Ni. - 51/9

- Involuntary movements
- Irrelevant and incomprehensible speech
- Altered state of consciousness
- Tingling sensation
- Sluggish movements of the body parts
- Pain abdomen
- Darkness in front of the eyes
- Giddiness
- Confusion
- Horripilation

Kaphaja Amlapitta

कफनिष्ठीवनगौरवजडतारुचिशीतसादय मिलेपाः।
वहनवलसादकण्डनिनाहिं कफानुगते॥१०॥

Ma.Ni. - 51/10

- Expectoration of sputum
- Heaviness of the body
- Tastelessness
- Coldness of the body
- Sluggish movement of the body parts
- Vomiting
- Coating over the tongue
- Loss of appetite
- Itching

Vata-kaphaja Amlapitta

उभयमिदमेव चिह्नं मारुतकफसंभवे भवत्यम्ले।

Ma.Ni. - 51/11

- In case of Vata-kaphaja Amlapitta, mixed features of Vataja and Kaphaja Amlapitta are observed.

Kaphapittaja Amlapitta

(तिकालकटुकोद्गारहृत्कुक्षिकण्ठदाहकृत्॥११॥)

भ्रमो मूर्च्छाचिश्छर्दिरालस्यं च शिरोरुजा।

प्रसेको मुखमाधुर्ये श्लेष्मपित्तस्य लक्षणम्॥12॥ Ma.Ni. – 51/ 11,12

- ⊗ Bitter or sour or pungent eructations
- ⊗ Burning sensation in the chest region
- ⊗ Burning sensation in the abdomen
- ⊗ Burning sensation in the throat
- ⊗ Giddiness
- ⊗ Altered state of consciousness
- ⊗ Tastelessness
- ⊗ Vomiting
- ⊗ Laziness

- ⊗ Headache
- ⊗ Excess salivation
- ⊗ Sweetish taste in the mouth

Sadhyasadyata of Amlapitta

रोगोऽयमम्लपित्ताख्यो यत्नात् संसाध्यते नवः।

चिरोत्थितो भवेद्वाप्यः कृच्छ्रसाध्यः स कस्यचित्॥17॥

Ma.Ni. – 51/7

- ⊗ Amlapitta of recent onset is curable with much effort¹²
- ⊗ Amlapitta of longer duration is considered to be palliable, but sometimes is treatable with difficulty if proper care is being given¹³

Key points of the chapter

- ⊗ अम्लपित्तं चेति अम्लगुणोद्भूतं पित्तम्॥
- ⊗ Amlapitta is a spectrum of the diseases where we are going to observe the Amlatva (sourness) to be increased in the body. This is presented with burning sensation of the chest and throat, sour or bitter eructation from the mouth and indigestion due to the abnormal functioning of Pitta.
- ⊗ The Nidana mentioned in the context of Amlapitta is responsible for the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta in the body which in turn leads to the vitiation of Pitta Dosha in its Ushna, Tikshna qualities. Most of the Lakshana mentioned in the context of Amlapitta indicates the abnormal increase of Pitta Dosha in the body.
- ⊗ No Purvarupa are mentioned in the context of Amlapitta.
- ⊗ 2 types of Amlapitta are mentioned based on the movement of abnormal Pitta in the body. They are Urdhvaga and Adhoga Amlapitta. Based on the Dosha dominance in the manifestation of the disease, 4 types are described. They are Vataja, Vatakaphaja, Kaphaja and Kaphapittaja Amlapitta.

Self-Assessment: Questions for Review

Long essays

- ⊗ Define Amlapitta. Explain Nidana, Samprapti, Samprapti Ghataka and Bheda of Amlapitta

- ⊗ Write a short note on Urdhvaga Amlapitta
- ⊗ Write a short note on Adhoga Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain in brief about Samanya Lakshana of Amlapitta

Short essays

- ⊗ Explain the Samprapti and Samprapti Ghataka of Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain the Nidana of Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain Samanya Lakshana of Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain the types of Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain Urdhvaga Amlapitta
- ⊗ Explain Adhoga Amlapitta

MCQs

1. Types of Amlapitta based on movement of vitiated Pitta are

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| a. 2; | b. 3; |
| c. 5; | d. 4 |

Answer: (a)

2. Types of Amlapitta based on Dosha dominance as per Madhavakara are

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| a. 2; | b. 3; |
| c. 4; | d. 5 |

Answer: (c)

3. Anubandhya Dosha in the process of manifestation of Amlapitta is

- | | |
|-----------|----------|
| a. Pitta; | b. Vata; |
|-----------|----------|

Short answers

- ⊗ Define Amlapitta
- ⊗ Enumerate the types of Amlapitta
- ⊗ Enumerate the types of Amlapitta based on Dosha dominance

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- 12 Usually Amlapitta of recent onset is usually having the mild exposure of the aetiological factor for the manifestation of the disease. The deeper Dhatu involvement will not be observed in this situation, hence the disease is curable if proper plan of treatment is adopted.
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- c. Vata and Kapha; d. Vata or Kapha

Answer: (a)

4. Dosha responsible for the manifestation of Urdhvaga Amlapitta are

- a. Pitta Kapha; b. Pitta Vata;
c. Vata Kapha; d. Vata Pitta

Answer: (a)

5. Type of Udgara (belching) seen in the patient of Amlapitta is/are

- a. Tiktodgara;
b. Amlodgara;
c. Tikta or Amlodgara;
d. Madhura Udgara

Answer: (c)

6. Amlapitta are common intype of patients.

- a. Balyavastha;
b. Madhyamavastha;
c. Vriddhavastha;
d. All of the above

Answer: (b)

7. As per Kashyapa, Amlapitta is more commonly seen in

- a. Jangala Desha;
b. Sadharana Desha;
c. Anupa Desha;
d. All of the above

Answer: (c)

8. Which of the following is considered as Nidana of Amlapitta?

- a. Kulattha;
b. Madyapana;
c. Viruddhashana;
d. All of the above

Answer: (d)

9. As per Charaka, which of the following is considered as Amlapitta Jananam Shreshtham?

- a. Kulattha;
b. Madyapana;
c. Viruddhashana;
d. All of the above

Answer: (a)

10. Which of the following is specifically involved in Adhoga Amlapitta patients?

- a. Mutravaha Srotas;
b. Artavavaha Srotas;
c. Purishavaha Srotas;
d. None of the above

Answer: (c)

Chapter resources

- ⊗ Madhava Nidana 51st chapter – Amlapitta Nidana
- ⊗ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ⊗ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ⊗ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ⊗ Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ⊗ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
